



TIPS & TRICKS



Combining columns of two different files

Paste is a wonderful tool to combine columns of two different files.

Here is an example:

```
$cat 1
1
2
3
$cat a
a
b
c
$paste 1 a
1 a
2 b
3 c
```

—Aravindan, aravindanj01@gmail.com



Make parent and children directories together, using a single command

You can do this by using *mkdir* with the *-p* option where:

```
$ mkdir -p programming/BASHscripting/tutorials/StepByStep
```

is the same as

```
- $ mkdir programming
- $ cd programming
~/programming $ mkdir BASHscripting
~/programming $ cd BASHscripting
~/programming/BASHscripting $ mkdir tutorials
~/programming/BASHscripting $ cd tutorials
~/programming/BASHscripting/tutorials/
~/S $ mkdir StepByStep
~/programming/BASHscripting/tutorials/ $ cd StepByStep
```

As you can see above, using *mkdir* with the *-p* option can save you a lot of time and effort.

—Vijay Soni, vs4vijay@gmail.com



Disable the USB port on Linux Redhat Server 5

Do you want to disable the USB port on your workstation so that no one is able to access it or copy your data using a pen drive? Here is one solution.

To disable the USB port on your machine that runs Linux Redhat Server 5, you need to first edit the *grub.conf* file by typing the following command:

```
# vi /boot/grub/grub.conf
```

Then add a kernel parameter, as shown below:

```
kernel /vmlinuz ..... rhgb quiet nousb
```

Save and exit the file you were editing, and reboot your machine. Now, no one can access anything through the USB port of your machine, as all the ports have been disabled.

—Sumit Nandi, sumitnandi@yahoo.com



Setting up a special access control list

Try setting an access control list or *acl* to a directory file, which is already a mount point (for example *'/backup'* will be the mount point) of any permanently mounted file system. You will generally get the error message: Operation not permitted. In order to set *acl* to such a directory file, which is already a mount point for a file system, you can modify the *fstab* in the following way.

Open the *fstab* file in any text editor using the command given below:

```
# vi /etc/fstab
```